

2025 HSC German Continuers

Marking Guidelines

Section I — Listening and Responding

Question 1

Criteria	Marks
• Explains why this item is special	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

The cuckoo clock comes from the Black Forest where Grandpa was born. (This makes it an ideal Christmas present for him.)

Question 2 (a)

Criteria	Marks
• Identifies why an apology is being made	1

Sample answer:

The flight has been delayed.

Question 2 (b)

Criteria	Marks
• Identifies the instructions given	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Passengers are instructed to be patient. Families with small children and guests with mobility issues are asked to go to the gate.

Question 3 (a)

Criteria	Marks
• Accounts for Dieter's frustration with Christiane	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Dieter is frustrated with Christiane because he wants to use the car but he can't find the car key. Christiane was the last person to use the car and the key isn't in the usual place.

Question 3 (b)

Criteria	Marks
• Identifies the correct answer	1

Sample answer:

C

Question 4

Criteria	Marks
• Provides a sound explanation of why Erika is likely to accept Florian's suggestion of a rock climbing party	3
• Provides some explanation of why Erika is likely to accept Florian's suggestion of a rock climbing party	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Although Erika was initially worried that rock climbing would be too dangerous for ten-year-olds, she was reassured by the constant supervision provided. She accepts that climbing would be something unusual and different, unlike the usual bowling or movies. She is further persuaded by the convenient location, the inclusion of party food and that the adults can relax in the café.

Question 5

Criteria	Marks
• Provides a thorough evaluation of Heike's suitability for this role	4
• Provides a sound evaluation of Heike's suitability for this role	3
• Demonstrates some understanding of Heike's suitability for this role	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Heike is entirely suitable for the role of accompanying the school robotics team to Barcelona. Her previous experience will help the students succeed. She is pleased to apply her knowledge of the Spanish language and culture to help the group enjoy the experience.

Question 6

Criteria	Marks
• Demonstrates a perceptive understanding of the extent to which Jürgen's attitude is justified, with detailed reference to the text	5
• Demonstrates a thorough understanding of the extent to which Jürgen's attitude is justified, with reference to the text	4
• Demonstrates a sound understanding of the extent to which Jürgen's attitude is justified, with some reference to the text	3
• Provides some understanding of Jürgen's attitude	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Although Jürgen has valid reasons why he doesn't want to move to Lake Constance with his father, his attitude is not entirely justified.

Jürgen is being selfish by focusing on what he'll leave behind – friends, job, sports team, and not on what his father will gain – working from home and leisure activities. The fact that Jürgen will be going to university next year means everything is going to change anyway. Jürgen is insensitive in ignoring his father's dream and the lifestyle that the move to Constance could bring.

Question 7

Criteria	Marks
Provides a perceptive justification of Katja's change of emotions throughout the conversation, with detailed reference to language and content	5
Provides a thorough justification of Katja's change of emotions throughout the conversation, with reference to language and content	4
Provides a sound justification of Katja's change of emotions throughout the conversation, with some reference to language and/or content	3
Demonstrates some understanding of Katja's emotions	2
Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

At the beginning of the conversation, Katja is angry because she doesn't feel valued at work and is always expected to be available to work weekends. She is particularly upset because she had made plans for the weekend that can't be changed at short notice. She shows her frustration through the use of emotive language and exclamations (eg *unglaublich* – unbelievable/ *Ich habe die Nase voll* – I've had it up to here/ *das ist mir wirklich zu viel* – it's just too much).

Her use of rhetorical questions and sarcasm (eg *Warum bin ich immer Diejenige, die den Kaffee holen muss? Deswegen bin ich nicht zur Uni gegangen, oder?* – Why am I always the one who has to get the coffee? That's not why I went to uni, is it?) further underlines her annoyance.

Katja is surprised when Leo offers to take her shift for her as this is the first act of kindness she has been shown at work, evident in the use of a rhetorical question (eg *Wirklich? Das würdest du echt tun?* – Really? You would really do that for me?).

She is overjoyed when Leo offers to help her. This is expressed through the use of exclamatory language (eg *Wirklich?* – really?; *Juhu!* – woo hoo!).

Section II — Reading and Responding

Part A

Question 8 (a)

Criteria	Marks
• Identifies the purpose of the article	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

To encourage students' participation in sport for fun throughout life (which is the new theme for the school year).

Question 8 (b)

Criteria	Marks
• Identifies what Martin is referring to	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Martin says 'and that's how it all began' to refer to how his love for football started. His father gave him his first football as soon as he could walk.

Question 8 (c)

Criteria	Marks
• Demonstrates a thorough understanding of the extent to which Martin is an inspiration to the students	4
• Demonstrates a sound understanding of the extent to which Martin is an inspiration to the students	3
• Demonstrates some understanding of the extent to which Martin is an inspiration to the students	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Martin is a major inspiration to the students. Despite not achieving his dream of being a professional football player, football is still an important part of his life. He has applied the values that football has taught him to his whole life – perseverance, dealing with success and failure, teamwork and self-confidence. Martin gives back to the community as a volunteer coach, instilling his passion into young people.

Question 8 (d)

Criteria	Marks
• Demonstrates a thorough understanding of what is revealed about Natalie's personality in this article, with reference to the text	4
• Demonstrates a sound understanding of what is revealed about Natalie's personality in this article, with some reference to the text	3
• Demonstrates some understanding of what is revealed about Natalie's personality in this article	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

At school Natalie was passionate about gymnastics. She was only happy in the school gym. Her dedication and singlemindedness towards gymnastics often resulted in her coming late to class, making her something of a rebel. Although she had a casual attitude towards her studies, she still managed to achieve satisfactory grades. Natalie is ambitious, as shown through her desire to be the best. Her determination to succeed has led to a successful career as a dancer.

Question 9 (a)

Criteria	Marks
• Identifies what all three bloggers agree on	1

Sample answer:

All bloggers agree that they always look forward to the latest novels by Oskar B.

Question 9 (b)

Criteria	Marks
• Explains why Paula has the attitude expressed in the blog post	3
• Demonstrates some understanding of Paula's attitude in the blog post	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Paula's anticipation of Oskar B.'s new novel has been rewarded. She finds it refreshing that the author has departed from his usual genre. As she is no longer able to travel, she is excited to be transported to the African jungle from the comfort of her lounge.

Question 9 (c)

Criteria	Marks
• Provides a thorough explanation of why Quentin says this	4
• Provides a sound explanation of why Quentin says this	3
• Provides some explanation of why Quentin says this	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Quentin says 'it simply leaves me cold' to express his disappointment with this novel. The promises of the title and colourful cover of the novel were not fulfilled. He disapproved of the author's departure from his usual writing style and found it tedious. As an adventure story, he feels the novel has missed the mark by focussing on the characters.

Question 9 (d)

Criteria	Marks
• Provides a perceptive explanation of how Renate uses language to convey her point of view	5
• Provides a thorough explanation of how Renate uses language to convey her point of view	4
• Provides a sound explanation of how Renate uses language to convey her point of view	3
• Provides some explanation of how Renate uses language to convey her point of view	2
• Provides some relevant information	1

Sample answer:

Renate has mixed feelings about the latest novel. Her enthusiastic anticipation for the new novel is demonstrated through the idiomatic expression 'to jump for joy' (*springe in die Luft*). Her use of repetitive hyperbole (*etwas so Verzauberndes, so Entzückendes*) shows her appreciation of the beautiful descriptions of the landscape. She says she feels connected to the characters from Oskar B.'s previous novels and identifies with them. However, for these familiar characters she finds the new setting of this sequel implausible, as shown through the use of exclamations (*verrückt!*). She expresses her disillusionment with the author's unrealistic treatment of the characters in the jungle setting through rhetorical questions (*Im Ernst? Was zum Teufel...?*) and sarcasm (*der liebe Oskar B.*).

Section II — Reading and Responding

Part B

Question 10

Criteria	Marks
• Demonstrates an excellent understanding of the whole text • Manipulates language authentically and creatively to meet the requirements of the task • Organises information and ideas to meet the requirements of the task	13–15
• Demonstrates a good understanding of the text • Manipulates language with some degree of authenticity and creativity to meet the requirements of the task • Organises information and ideas to meet the requirements of the task	10–12
• Responds to some of the questions, statements, comments and/or specific information in the text • Demonstrates a satisfactory knowledge and understanding of vocabulary and sentence structures • Attempts to structure relevant information and ideas	7–9
• Responds to some of the questions, statements, comments and/or specific information in the text • Demonstrates a basic knowledge and understanding of vocabulary and sentence structures • Demonstrates limited ability to link information and ideas or structure text	4–6
• Responds to isolated elements in the text • Uses single words or set formulae to express information	1–3

Section III — Writing in German

Question 11

Criteria	Marks
- Writes effectively and appropriately in relation to the audience, purpose and context of the task - Manipulates vocabulary, language structures and features authentically and creatively relevant to the task	5
- Writes with a good understanding of the audience, purpose and context of the task - Demonstrates a good understanding of vocabulary, language structures and features relevant to the task	4
- Writes with some awareness of the audience, purpose and context of the task - Demonstrates some understanding of vocabulary, language structures and features relevant to the task	2–3
Produces some comprehensible language relevant to the task	1

Section III (continued)

Question 12

Criteria	Marks
- Writes effectively and appropriately for the audience, purpose and context of the task - Manipulates language structures authentically and creatively relevant to the task - Sequences and structures ideas and information coherently and effectively	10
- Writes with a good understanding of the audience, purpose and context of the task - Demonstrates an excellent understanding of language structures relevant to the task - Sequences and structures ideas and information effectively	8–9
- Writes with an understanding of the audience, purpose and context of the task - Demonstrates a good understanding of language structures relevant to the task - Organises some information and ideas	6–7
- Presents some information, opinions or ideas relevant to the task - Demonstrates a rudimentary understanding of vocabulary and sentence structures - Attempts to organise information and ideas	4–5
- Attempts to address the requirements of the task - Uses single words, set formulae and unrelated sentences to express information	2–3
Produces some comprehensible language relevant to the task	1

2025 HSC German Continuers Mapping Grid

Oral Examination

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
	20	Conversation covering student's personal world	H1.1, H1.2, H1.3, H1.4

Written Examination

Section I — Listening and Responding

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
1	2	People and places — dialogue	H3.1
2 (a)	1	Tourism and hospitality — announcement	H3.1
2 (b)	2	Tourism and hospitality — announcement	H3.1
3 (a)	2	Leisure and lifestyles — voicemail message	H3.5
3 (b)	1	Leisure and lifestyles — voicemail message	H3.5
4	3	Arts and entertainment — dialogue	H3.4
5	4	Education and aspirations — speech	H3.5
6	5	Personal identity — face-to-face conversation	H3.4
7	5	The world of work — face-to-face conversation	H3.6

Section II — Reading and Responding

Part A

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
8 (a)	2	Leisure and lifestyles — article	H3.3
8 (b)	2	Leisure and lifestyles — article	H3.5
8 (c)	4	Leisure and lifestyles — article	H3.5
8 (d)	4	Leisure and lifestyles — article	H3.5
9 (a)	1	Arts and entertainment — blog post	H3.4
9 (b)	3	Arts and entertainment — blog post	H3.1
9 (c)	4	Arts and entertainment — blog post	H3.4
9 (d)	5	Arts and entertainment — blog post	H3.6

Section II — Reading and Responding

Part B

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
10	15	Past and present — letter	H2.1, H2.2, H2.3, H3.1

Section III — Writing in German

Question	Marks	Content	Syllabus outcomes
11	5	Personal identity — message	H2.1, H2.2, H2.3
12 (a)	10	Tourism and hospitality — diary entry	H2.1, H2.2, H2.3
12 (b)	10	Education and aspirations — diary entry	H2.1, H2.2, H2.3